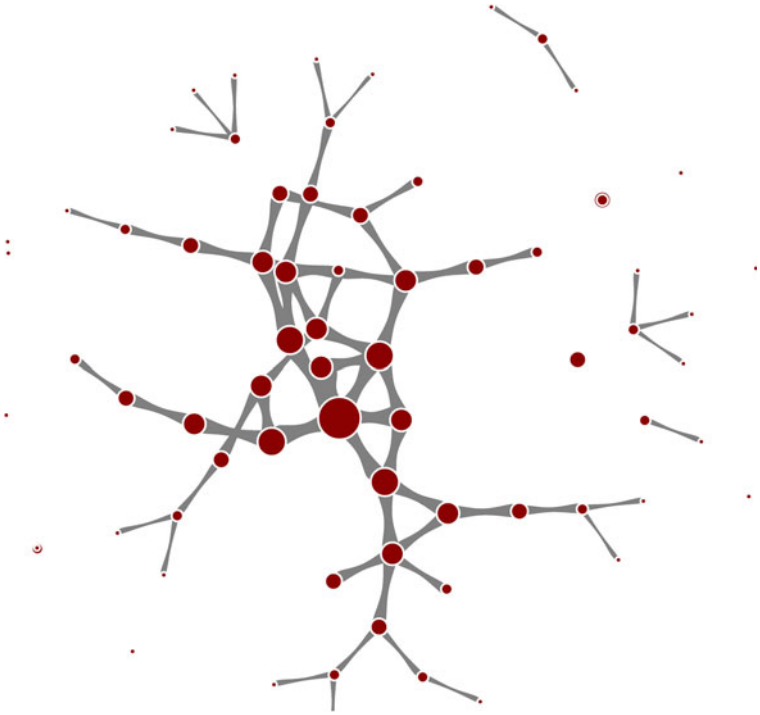


Figure 1.29 Network data consists of objects and the connections between them. The objects are typically referred to as nodes or vertices, while the connections are referred to as edges or links. Networks are often represented using force-directed algorithms, such as the example here, that arrange the network in such a way as to pull connected nodes toward each other.

such, but the flexibility of this representation is worth the effort. You'll see hierarchical data in detail in chapter 5 when we look at various popular D3 layouts.

1.4.3 Network data

Networks are everywhere. Whether they're the raw output of social networking streams, transportation networks, or a flowchart, networks are a powerful method of delivering an understanding of complex systems. Networks are often represented as node-link diagrams, as shown in figure 1.29. Like geographic data, network data has many standards, but this text focuses only on two forms: node/edge lists and connected arrays. Network data can also be easily transformed into these data types by using a freely available network analysis tool like Gephi (available at gephi.org). We'll examine network data and network data standards when we deal with network visualization in chapter 6.

1.4.4 Geographic data

Geographic data refers to locations either as points or shapes, and is used to create the variety of online maps seen on the web today, such as the map of the United States in figure 1.30. The incredible popularity of web mapping means that you can get access